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BSIT-3

## PICO CTF- CHALLENGE 5

PcapPoisoning



### 1. Download the PCAP FILE

The challenge provided a network capture file.

*wget*

*<https://artifacts.picoctf.net/c/377/trace.pcap>*

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Hints ?

Description

(None)

How about some hide and seek heh?

Download this [file](#) and find the flag.

21,244 users solved



76%

Liked



picoCTF{FLAG}

Submit  
Flag

### 2. Search for readable strings in the PCAP

Because .pcap files contain binary data, the strings command helps extract readable text.

*string trace.pcap*

```
P Pantine23-picoctf@webshell:~$ cat trace.pcap | grep "pic"
grep: (standard input): binary file matches
Pantine23-picoctf@webshell:~$ cat trace.pcap | grep "pico"
grep: (standard input): binary file matches
Pantine23-picoctf@webshell:~$ cat trace.pcap | grep "picoctf"
Pantine23-picoctf@webshell:~$ strings trace.pcap
username root password toorF~
iBwawNvQ1RGe1Flag is close=F~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
```

### 3. Analyze the extracted data

While scrolling through the output, multiple encoded-looking strings appeared such as:

*gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~*

and also, a message hint:

*Flag is close*

### 4. Locate the flag

Near the end of the output, the flag was revealed:

***picoCTF{P64P\_4N4L7S1S\_SU55355FUL\_31010c46}***

```
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
picoCTF{P64P_4N4L7S1S_SU55355FUL_31010c46}F~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
gc2VjcmV0OiBwawNvQ1RGeF~
```

### Short Reflection

This challenge demonstrated how **network packet captures can contain hidden information inside transmitted data**. By using the strings command, readable content from the PCAP file was extracted, making it easier to locate the flag without deep packet analysis. It shows how simple forensic tools

can quickly reveal sensitive information if data is not properly protected.